CONFIDENTIAL • INTERNAL SUPPORT OPERATIONS MANUAL

AcmeCloud Customer Support Knowledge Base & SOP

Standard Operating Procedures, Tiered SLA Policies, and Technical Resolution Guidelines

1. Subscription Billing & Refund Policy

Standard terms under which support agents may authorize customer refunds, subscription cancellations, and plan adjustments.

Policy Area	Standard Guideline	Agent Authority Limit
Annual Plans	30-day full money-back guarantee from date of initial purchase or renewal.	Full refund approval without manager sign-off if within 30 days.
Monthly Plans	Monthly charges are non-refundable once billed. Prorated service credits offered upon request.	Up to 1 month service credit ($150 limit).
Add-On Services	Dedicated IP addresses, custom domain registration, and onboarding fees are strictly non-refundable.	No agent exceptions permitted.
Cancellation & Data Retention	Cancellations take effect at the end of the active billing period. Cloud storage and telemetry snapshots are preserved for 60 calendar days before permanent cryptographic shredding.	Can extend grace retention up to 30 days upon customer request.

2. Technical Incident Resolution Guidelines

Verified troubleshooting procedures for recurring cloud infrastructure issues.

HTTP 504 Gateway Timeout Errors

Diagnosis: Occurs when the reverse proxy (Nginx or Cloudflare edge) does not receive a response from upstream workers (Gunicorn/Node) within 60 seconds.

- Inspect upstream worker resource saturation via Prometheus: verify CPU utilization and memory RSS.
- Check Nginx timeout configuration in `/etc/nginx/conf.d/proxy.conf`. Increase `proxy_read_timeout` from default `60s` to `120s` for batch export routes.
- Examine slow query logs in PostgreSQL (`log_min_duration_statement = 2000`) to identify missing indexes on large transactional tables.

SSL / TLS Certificate Validation Failures

Diagnosis: Customers report browser or API client errors: `SSL_ERROR_EXPIRED_CERT_DATE` or `CERT_UNTRUSTED`.

- Verify certificate renewal status: run `acme.sh --list` or `certbot certificates` on the ingress controller.

- Ensure the intermediate certificate chain is bundled properly; clients require `fullchain.pem`, not just `cert.pem`.
- Trigger manual renewal: `acme.sh --renew -d api.customerdomain.com --force`.

API Rate Limiting (HTTP 429 Too Many Requests)

Rate limits are calculated across sliding 60-second windows based on organization API tokens:

- **Standard Plan:** 100 requests per minute. Burst ceiling: 150 requests.
- **Professional Plan:** 1,000 requests per minute. Burst ceiling: 1,500 requests.
- **Enterprise Plan:** 10,000 requests per minute with dedicated Redis token-bucket clusters.
- **Remediation:** Advise customers to inspect the `Retry-After` HTTP response header and configure exponential backoff with random jitter in their client SDK.

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3. Support SLA Targets & Escalation Matrix

Categorization criteria and initial response SLAs for customer tickets:

Severity	Definition & Impact	First Response SLA	Escalation Contact
P1 - Critical	Production system down, severe security incident, or catastrophic data loss with no viable workaround.	< 15 minutes (24/7/365)	DevOps On-Call Engineer & Director of Operations
P2 - Major	Core feature severely impaired, critical API endpoints failing, multiple enterprise accounts affected.	< 1 hour (24/7/365)	Tier 2 Senior Engineering Lead
P3 - Standard	Non-critical operational bug with functional workaround, general billing or subscription queries.	< 4 business hours	Tier 1 Support Queue
P4 - Low	Feature requests, minor aesthetic defects, documentation inquiries, general advisory questions.	< 24 business hours	Product & Documentation Team

4. Account Access & Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) Recovery

Identity validation protocol before resetting 2FA credentials:

- **Verification Challenge:** Customer must prove domain ownership via DNS TXT challenge: `_acme-verify=<one-time-token>` or confirm via primary contract billing email.
- **Emergency Lockdown:** In the event of suspected credential compromise, immediately revoke active OAuth tokens and terminate live sessions via Admin Dashboard.
- **Audit Logging:** Every 2FA reset must cite the corresponding Zendesk ticket number in the administrative audit log.